Ridha Chehime

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Objective

Seeking to immerse in the day-to-day operations of information security and cybersecurity teams at major organizations to gain practical, real-world experience in designing security controls and the detection and prevention of security events. With a diverse background in penetration testing, networking, and exposure in leveraging AI/ML for business applications transformation, eager to contribute and add value to organizations' various initiatives and goals. Particular interest in pursuing a SOC analyst and Incident response opportunities and continuously expanding my expertise in cybersecurity

Education & Certifications

Western Michigan University, Kalamazoo Kalamazoo, MI

B.S. in Cybersecurity - Minor in Data Science *Graduating April 2026*

Post Graduate Program Certificate in AI & Machine Learning: Business Applications

The University of Texas at Austin - McCombs School of Business *May 2025 - January 2026*

- Developed practical exposure in AI powered business application transformation projects
- Gained particular experience in eight industry-relevant projects, including applications like sentiment analysis in finance, AI-powered medical assistants, and legal document summarization
- Strengthened my knowledge in Python, data preprocessing, model training and deployment

ISC2 Certifications

Certified in Cybersecurity (CC) *June 2025 - May 2028*

CompTIA Certifications *(In Progress)*

Network+ (Expected April 2026) and Security+ (Expected April 2026)

Work Experience

Lee Honors College Western Michigan University Kalamazoo, MI

Peer Student Success Team Assistant Coordinator & Mentor *August 2023 – Present*

- Facilitated academic and social support by guiding new honors students through mentorship and peer support
- Organized academic, volunteer, and community events to enhance student engagement, leveraging leadership and event planning skills to create peer connections

College of Engineering Western Michigan University Kalamazoo, MI

Research Assistant *May 2023 – August 2023*

- Conducted in-depth research on Goal Structuring Notations in autonomous vehicles, applying analytical skills to support advancements in system safety and reliability
- Collected and analyzed large datasets and designed experiments to support autonomous system safety research, ensuring integrity and accuracy while documenting and improving outcomes

Projects & Relevant Coursework

Periodic Access Review System (Senior Design Project)

Developed a full-stack access review system automating roster comparison, exception tracking, and compliance validation to enforce least-privilege access controls

Network & Vulnerability Scanner

Developed a Scapy-based vulnerability scanner performing ICMP, TCP, and ARP scans with CVE and SSL/TLS analysis

OWASP Juice Shop Pen-Testing

Performed penetration testing on OWASP Juice Shop, identifying vulnerabilities like XSS, SQL injection, and authentication flaws

Password Manager

Developed an offline desktop password manager in Python with AES-256 encryption, TOTP MFA, password strength analysis, reuse detection, and age-based alerts

Skills

Skills: Python, Java, JavaScript, C, Bash, SQL (MySQL), HTML, CSS, R

Security Tools: Nmap, Wireshark, OWASP ZAP, Burp Suite, Snort, Metasploit

Tools & Platforms: Linux (Ubuntu, Fedora, Kali), Windows, Docker, Kubernetes, GitHub, Agile, Django